

Sales Playbook

Commercial Analytics Division — Field Edition

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Owner: Sales Operations

1. Sales Methodology

Our sales motion is built on the **MEDDPICC** framework. Every opportunity in Salesforce must have MEDDPICC fields completed before moving from Stage 3 to Stage 4.

Letter	Element	What to capture
M	Metrics	Quantify the economic impact for the buyer
E	Economic Buyer	Person who controls the budget
D	Decision Criteria	Formal scoring rubric
D	Decision Process	Every approval step and timeline
P	Paper Process	Legal, security, procurement requirements
I	Identify Pain	Connect solution to a felt business problem
C	Champion	Build and coach an internal advocate
C	Competition	Know who else is in the deal

2. Qualification Criteria

A qualified opportunity must satisfy **all three** of the following criteria:

a) Budget Confirmed

Economic buyer confirmed budget of at least **USD 50,000 ACV**. Deals below this threshold route to inside sales.

b) Timeline Confirmed

Prospect has a stated decision date within 12 months. No-timeline deals park in Nurture.

c) Problem-Solution Fit

At least one of the following business pains must be documented:

- Manual reporting consuming more than 20 hours per analyst per week
- Inability to consolidate data from more than three source systems
- Board-level reporting errors in the last two quarters
- Compliance audit findings related to data lineage

POLICY: Opportunities not meeting all three criteria within 45 days must be disqualified.

3. Deal Stages and Exit Criteria

Stage	Name	Exit Criteria
1	Prospecting	Discovery call done, pain identified, economic buyer named
2	Discovery	Technical requirements gathered, solution fit confirmed
3	Solution Presented	MEDDPICC 80% complete, verbal interest from economic buyer
4	Proposal Sent	Verbal or written acceptance of commercial terms
5	Negotiation	All terms agreed, contract ready for signature
6	Closed Won/Lost	Signature received or deal formally withdrawn

Target stage velocity: S1-S2: 14 days | S2-S3: 21 days | S3-S4: 14 days | S4-S5: 10 days | S5-S6: 7 days

4. Closing Techniques

4.1 The Assumptive Close

Used when the prospect has given multiple positive signals. The rep assumes forward momentum:
'Based on what we have agreed, shall we target April 1st for go-live?'

4.2 The Summary Close

Used at Stage 5 to reduce hesitation by recapping agreed economic value. Confirm payback period.

4.3 The Competitive Close

Acknowledge competitor strength, pivot to differentiation, ask for decision-criteria clarification.

4.4 The Limited-Time Close

Used only when a genuine, verifiable time-bound incentive exists.

Do not fabricate urgency. Reps caught using false urgency will receive a formal warning under the Sales Code of Conduct.

5. Discovery Call Structure — 45 Minutes

Time	Segment	Purpose
00-05 min	Agenda setting	Rapport, confirm attendees
05-15 min	Current state	How is the prospect solving the problem today?
15-25 min	Pain exploration	SPIN: Situation, Problem, Implication, Need-Payoff
25-35 min	Solution mapping	High-level fit discussion
35-40 min	Next steps	Agree specific actions with owners and dates
40-45 min	Administrative	Stakeholder list, technical contact, RFP timeline

Always send a call summary email within 2 hours containing: three key pains identified, agreed next steps with due dates, and any commitments made by the rep.

6. Competitive Intelligence — Q1 2024

DataRival Inc.

- Strengths: Mature BI/visualisation layer, strong brand in Retail
- Weaknesses: No native data lineage, 18-month implementation timelines
- Win rate vs DataRival: 58% (last four quarters)
- Counter: Emphasise audit trail and faster time-to-value

InsightBase

- Strengths: Low per-seat pricing, popular with SMB
- Weaknesses: Cannot handle >500M row datasets, no enterprise SLA
- Win rate vs InsightBase: 71%
- Counter: Scalability, enterprise support, security posture

AnalyticsPro (legacy)

- Strengths: Entrenched in Finance verticals, known brand
- Weaknesses: On-premise only, no cloud roadmap, high TCO
- Win rate vs AnalyticsPro: 63%
- Counter: Cloud-native, lower 3-year TCO, modern API

7. Escalation Policy

Condition	Required approver
Deal size > USD 500,000	VP sign-off on commercial terms
Deal size > USD 1,000,000	CFO review before Stage 4
Non-standard payment terms	Finance approval
Contract term > 3 years	Legal and CFO approval
Free pilot > 60 days	VP approval
Custom SLA commitments	Head of Customer Success approval

All escalations via the Salesforce Escalation Request flow. Turnaround: 2 business days (VP), 5 business days (CFO/Legal).